

The Human-AI Partnership Framework

Where human judgment belongs

Solution-to-Build

PCF 8.5 — Design & architect services/solutions — Value Stream Profile

This value stream comprises one APQC PCF process group: 8.5 Develop and Manage Services/Solutions — spanning 5 Level 3 processes and 22 Level 4 activities.

At the activity level, this value stream's work breaks down as 13 Knowledge activities (judgment, synthesis, and interpretation-driven work), 5 Transaction activities (rules-based processing suited to automation), 2 Document activities (content generation), 1 Decision activity, and 1 Exception activity.

At M3 (HITL Design Intent), the value stream's aggregate human-involvement ratio is 50%, down from a 73% undesigned baseline — a 23-point AI convergence opportunity.

L3 PROCESSES	L4 ACTIVITIES	M1 BASELINE H%	M3 DESIGN INTENT H%	Δ M1 → M3
5	22	73%	50%	-23%

KPIs

Business Impact Metric & Formula (where confirmed)	Source
Solution development cost ratio <i>% of total IT cost allocated to Develop and Maintain IT Solutions</i>	APQC OSB
Deployment Frequency <i>Number of successful production deployments per unit time, tracked per team/release cycle</i>	DORA
Lead Time for Changes <i>Elapsed time from code commit to successful production deployment</i>	DORA

Design Narrative

Solution-to-Build splits ownership along a design/execution line: Enterprise Architect holds Accountable for the stream's three design-facing L3s — development strategy (8.5.1), lifecycle planning (8.5.2), and solution architecture itself (8.5.3) — while DevOps Engineer and Systems Administrator hold Accountable directly for the two execution-facing L3s, service/solution creation and testing (8.5.4) and maintenance and testing (8.5.5), with no Managerial-tier owner in between. This is the same Operational-tier-Accountable pattern seen in PCF 7.0's Recruit-to-Hire: these are genuinely hands-on build/test/maintain activities where Enterprise Architect owns the blueprint but not the build. Its steepest AI-absorption opportunity sits in 8.5.1.2 (Define IT service/solution development processes/standards, Document-pattern, -32 points).

AI Capability Map

Pattern-type distribution across this value stream's activity units. H% figures are the pattern type's standard value at each maturity level, applied consistently across all PCF domains.

Decision <i>Judgment & Authority — gates that stay human by design</i> 1 L4 activities M1 92% → M3 80%	Knowledge <i>Synthesis & Interpretation — judgment-driven work</i> 13 L4 activities M1 85% → M3 65%	Document <i>Content Generation — drafting and communication</i> 2 L4 activities M1 72% → M3 40%	Transaction <i>Rules-Based Processing — suited to automation</i> 5 L4 activities M1 60% → M3 35%	Exception <i>Non-Standard Resolution — human-resolved by nature</i> 1 L4 activities M1 95% → M3 82%
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Process Accountability

Process Accountability	Tier	L3 Processes	L4 Activities
Enterprise Architect	Managerial	8.5.1, 8.5.2, 8.5.3	20
DevOps Engineer	Operational	8.5.4	1
Systems Administrator	Operational	8.5.5	1

Handoff Points

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The stream opens with Enterprise Architect owning the design-facing work: development strategy (8.5.1), lifecycle planning (8.5.2), and solution architecture itself (8.5.3).

It then hands to execution: DevOps Engineer picks up service/solution creation and testing (8.5.4) with Enterprise Architect retained as Consulted, and Systems Administrator closes the stream with maintenance and testing (8.5.5) — the design-to-build handoff this value stream is organized around.

Governed Decision Points

Every Decision/Exception-pattern activity in the value stream, including those embedded inside Mixed-labeled steps.

PCF	Decision	Authority	Impact	Escalates To	Trigger
8.5.1.5	Understand and select reusable service components	Enterprise Architect	Technical + Financial — build-vs-reuse decision affects cost and standards compliance	IT Director (Managerial)	No existing reusable component meets requirements, or component selection conflicts with architecture standards
8.5.3.8	Manage architectural exceptions	Enterprise Architect	Technical + Governance — formal deviation from approved architecture	IT Director (Managerial)	Proposed solution cannot meet Architecture Compliance without a documented, time-bound waiver

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